DRUGS · NASAL PREPARATIONS

# Naseptin and mupirocin

Naseptin is a nasal cream combining chlorhexidine (an antiseptic) and neomycin (an aminoglycoside). It treats nasal vestibulitis and crusting, reduces recurrent epistaxis in children, and decolonises Staphylococcus aureus. Mupirocin nasal ointment is the standard agent for MRSA decolonisation. Naseptin contains arachis (peanut) oil and must not be given to patients with a peanut or soya allergy.

## 1 CHAPTER ONE At a glance

The preparations on one page.

### 1.1 Summary

NASEPTIN AND MUPIROCIN

| | SUMMARY |
|---|---|
| **Preparations** | Naseptin: chlorhexidine dihydrochloride 0.1% and neomycin sulfate 0.5% cream (contains arachis oil); mupirocin 2% nasal ointment |
| **How they work** | Chlorhexidine disrupts bacterial membranes; neomycin inhibits protein synthesis; mupirocin inhibits isoleucyl-tRNA synthetase |
| **ENT uses** | Recurrent childhood epistaxis; nasal vestibulitis and crusting; after cautery to reduce crusting and rebleeding; S. aureus carriage (Naseptin); MRSA decolonisation before surgery (mupirocin) |
| **Doses** | Naseptin applied to the inside of each nostril four times daily for 10 days to eradicate staphylococci, or twice daily for 2 to 4 weeks for recurrent epistaxis; mupirocin to the inside of each nostril two or three times daily for 5 days, with chlorhexidine body wash |
| **Avoid** | Naseptin in peanut or soya allergy; mupirocin for longer than 10 days or repeated courses (resistance) |

# 2 CHAPTER TWO Using them in ENT

Indications.

## 2.1 Recurrent epistaxis in children

Bleeding from Little's area in children is often associated with vestibulitis and crusting; antiseptic cream for 4 weeks reduces bleeding about as well as silver nitrate cautery. Petroleum jelly is a cheaper alternative that also helps.

## 2.2 MRSA decolonisation

Before elective head and neck surgery in carriers: mupirocin nasally for 5 days with daily chlorhexidine washes, then re-screen.

# 3 CHAPTER THREE Safety

What goes wrong.

## 3.1 Adverse effects

Local irritation, rash; neomycin contact sensitivity; **anaphylaxis** in peanut allergy (Naseptin); mupirocin resistance with prolonged use.

# 4 CHAPTER FOUR For the examination

What the examiner wants to hear.

## 4.1 Viva essentials

> WHAT THE EXAMINER IS LOOKING FOR

- The arachis oil warning.
- Management of recurrent childhood epistaxis.
- MRSA decolonisation regimen.

## 4.2 Common pitfalls

COMMON PITFALLS

- Prescribing Naseptin without asking about nut allergy.
- Repeated courses of mupirocin.

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